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Once RFK Jr. allies, now confirmation foes

Democrats share complicated past with nominee

By Sam Brodey
GLOBE STAFF

WASHINGTON — Before he kept the company of Donald Trump, populist podcast personalities, and fringe conspiracy theorists, Robert F. Kennedy Jr. was a true Democratic insider — a political player who campaigned and fund-raised for his friends, pushed them on policy,

and enjoyed a Rolodex befitting a scion of his party's most beloved family.

In one of the many ironies of Kennedy's rise to power in Trump's orbit, it will be his one-time allies — politicians whom he once helped elect and who elevated his work — who could be his most aggressive interrogators in Senate hearings this week over his nomination to be secretary of health and human services.

Senator Sheldon Whitehouse of Rhode Island, who will question Kennedy, Page A6

US fires career prosecutors who investigated Trump

Move is latest in rapid series of seismic shifts regarding staff and direction of Justice Dept.

By Devlin Barrett, Karen Zraick, and Charlie Savage

NEW YORK TIMES

WASHINGTON — Acting Attorney General James McHenry on Monday fired more than a dozen prosecutors who worked on the two criminal investigations into Donald Trump for special counsel Jack Smith, saying they could not be trusted to "faithfully implement" the president's agenda, a Justice Department spokesperson said.

►Dust-up with Colombia's leader reveals the aggressive tactics of President Trump. A6.

Justice Department veterans called the firings an egregious violation of well-established laws meant to preserve the integrity and professionalism of government agencies.

What made it all the more jarring, current and former officials said, was that such

a momentous and aggressive step was initiated by an obscure acting attorney general, operating on behalf of a president with a stated desire for vengeance, and few advisers with the stature or inclination to restrain him.

The department did not identify the fired prosecutors. But a person who worked with some members of Smith's team said many of the dismissals appeared to target career lawyers and most likely violated civil service protections for nonpolitical employees.

The move was abrupt, but not unexpected. JUSTICE DEPARTMENT, Page A7



AFP VIA GETTY IMAGES

BOUND FOR HOME AMID THE RUINS

Thousands of displaced Palestinians walked along the coast of Gaza on Monday after Israel reopened access to the territory's north. Much of the mood was joyous as families, some holding babies or pushing wheelchairs, hauled their belongings in plastic bags and repurposed flour sacks through the central city of Nuseirat. A3.

Immigrant purge could imperil nursing home care

By Kay Lazar
GLOBE STAFF

She has lived through armed gangs seizing her home in Pernier, Haiti, and not knowing whether it's safe to walk outside. Now, when she closes her eyes at night, it's not gunfire that keeps her awake but fears that she will lose the new, tranquil life she's built in Massachusetts.

In the two short years since she fled Haiti, Erna trained as a nursing assistant, became certified, and now

works as a nurse aide in an assisted-living residence in Greater Boston.

"I don't want to go back to Haiti," said the 31-year-old Milton resident, who worked as an accountant in her home country. "It's not secure there." The Globe is not using Erna's full name because of concerns about her immigration status going forward.

Such fears and anxieties are coursing through health care facilities, especially in places where low-paid im-

NURSES, Page A10

Mass. bills seek cellphone ban in classrooms

By John Hilliard
GLOBE STAFF

Depression. Anxiety. Addiction. Health officials caution that social media use among young people is contributing to a growing mental health crisis. One former surgeon general has called for warnings about social media, like those for cigarettes.

Now, a group of Massachusetts state lawmakers and Attorney General Andrea Campbell have filed bills that would restrict students' access to smartphones when they're in school, with the goal of reducing the time they spend scrolling through platforms such as Instagram and TikTok.

Such protections are vital for young people, said Deb Schmill, whose 18-year-old daughter, Becca, died in 2020 from an accidental overdose of drugs laced with fentanyl she acquired through a dealer she met through social media. Her daughter began using drugs after she was allegedly raped by a teen she met through social media, and endured horrific cyberbullying, according to Schmill.

"We know that social media is purposely designed to keep our kids on constantly; that is not a mistake," said Schmill, a Canton resident who es-

CELLPHONES, Page A10

OFFSHORE SHAKING — Residents along the coast of New England felt tremors Monday morning from a 3.8 magnitude earthquake off Maine. No injuries were reported. B1.



Prosecutors linked a woman accused of shooting a border agent to death in Vermont to suspects in three homicides in Pennsylvania and California. B1.

Chicken farmers are on alert as officials surmise that bird flu has entered the state. D1.

A jolt of panic hit technology stocks as AI advances by Chinese companies threatened gains by US companies. D1.

A day of solemn ceremony was held near the former gas chambers and crematories of Auschwitz, recognizing it has been 80 years since that death camp was liberated. A3.

Wind oh pain

Tuesday: Wind then flurries. High 35-40, low 19-24.

Wednesday: Snow early. High 39-44, low 15-20.

Sunrise: 7:02. Sunset: 4:53.

Weather and comics, D5-6. Obituaries, C9.

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ON THE WINTRY PROWL The return of snowy owls to the region has attracted birders and photographers from across the nation. One soars near sundown at Duxbury Beach Reservation. B1.



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